



FIRST LIGHT

License to thrill

HOW 007 FIRST LIGHT STAYS TRUE TO IAN FLEMING'S JAMES BOND

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“The name is Bond, James Bond.” That is perhaps the first line that springs to mind the moment someone mentions the iconic MI6 agent 007. The interesting part, though, is that this exact line never really appeared in Ian Fleming’s novels, the works that gave birth to the legendary spy. Instead, it was the many films based on these novels that immortalised the phrase and turned it into one of the most recognisable introductions in pop culture.

Now, it isn’t uncommon for books to be adapted into films, and it isn’t uncommon for those films and novels to then inspire video games. The more creators reinterpret the same character, the more likely something fundamental will be altered, softened,

or completely lost in translation.

That, however, does not seem to be the case with 007: First Light. The upcoming title is the talk of the gaming world right now, and for good reason. After more than a decade away from the spotlight, Bond is returning to gaming in a way that feels both fresh and faithful.

Sony recently treated fans to a 30-minute deep dive into the game, offering the most comprehensive look yet at the world of 007: First Light. The game isn’t drawing directly from Fleming’s novels but is instead weaving an original storyline. Yet, when you look closely at the way Bond is written and presented in the game, you find echoes of the man who first appeared on Fleming’s pages. That matters, and it is also what makes this project feel like home for Bond fans who have been

following every pop culture take on him over the years.

So what exactly does 007: First Light get right about Bond? Quite a lot, as it turns out.

NOT TAKING ORDERS FROM ANYONE

One of the earliest signs that First Light understands Bond comes in a throwaway moment. In the gameplay video, his superior tells him to sit tight during an operation and stick to the plan. Bond, in classic Bond fashion, replies, “Okay, mom,” to her but still carries on exactly as he pleases. It’s a seemingly small exchange, but one that carries decades of weight.

Fleming’s Bond was rarely obedient. He respected M, he valued MI6, but he was never the type to colour inside the lines. His greatest asset was his judgement- his ability to